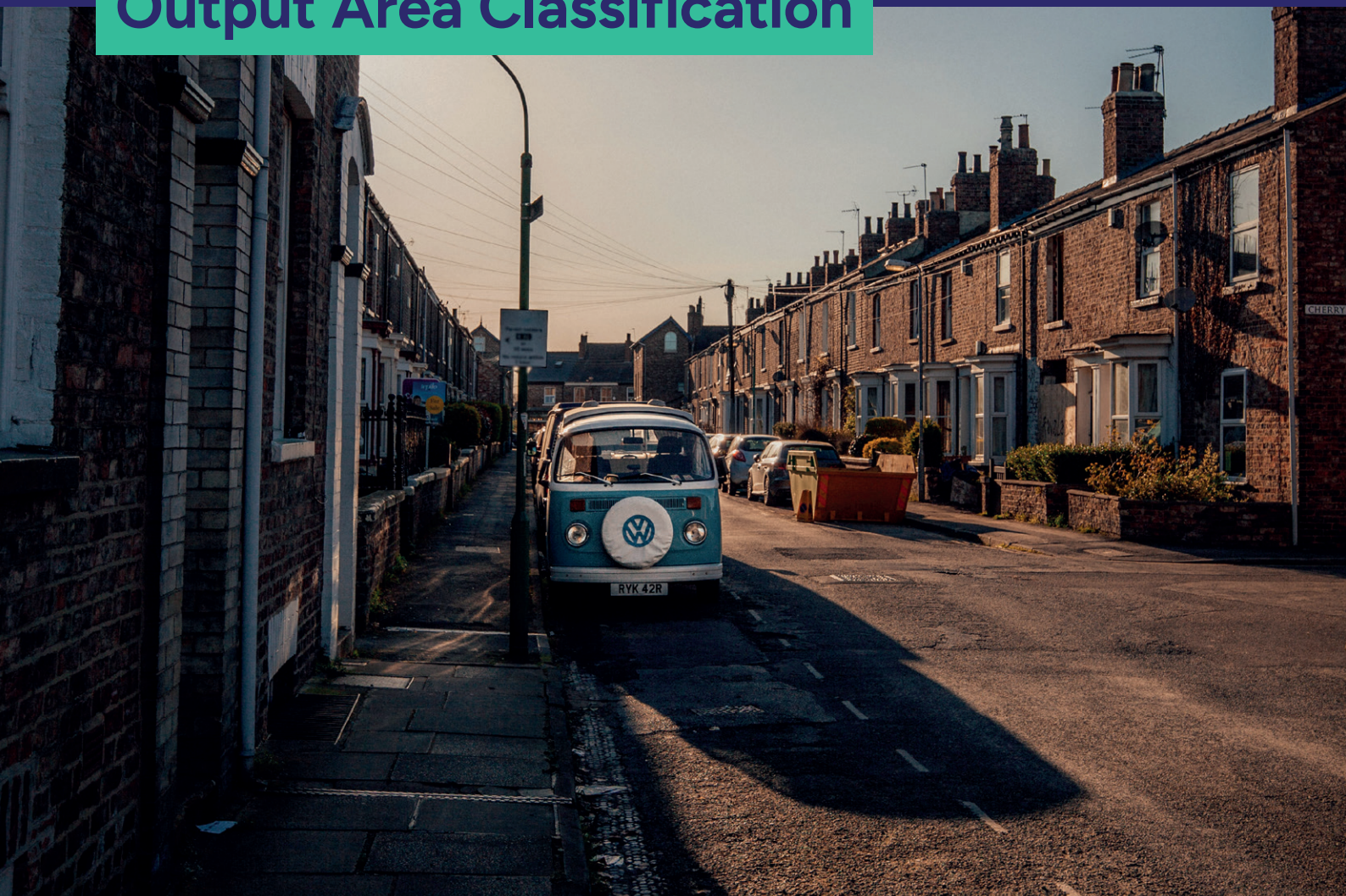


The UK's Geodemographic Structure

Output Area Classification



Output Area Classification

The UK Official Neighbourhood Geodemographic Classification

The 2021/2 Output Area Classification (OAC), created by the Geographic Data Service in collaboration with the Office for National Statistics (ONS), is a multi-tier small area neighbourhood classification of the UK. The classification is created using Census data and has a fully open and transparent methodology. The OAC can be used to understand the variegated structure of different neighbourhoods, and their local and regional settings, providing valuable context to issues in local and regional planning. Detailed profiles on the neighbourhood Supergroups, Groups and Subgroups can be found on the GeoDS website at data.geods.ac.uk.

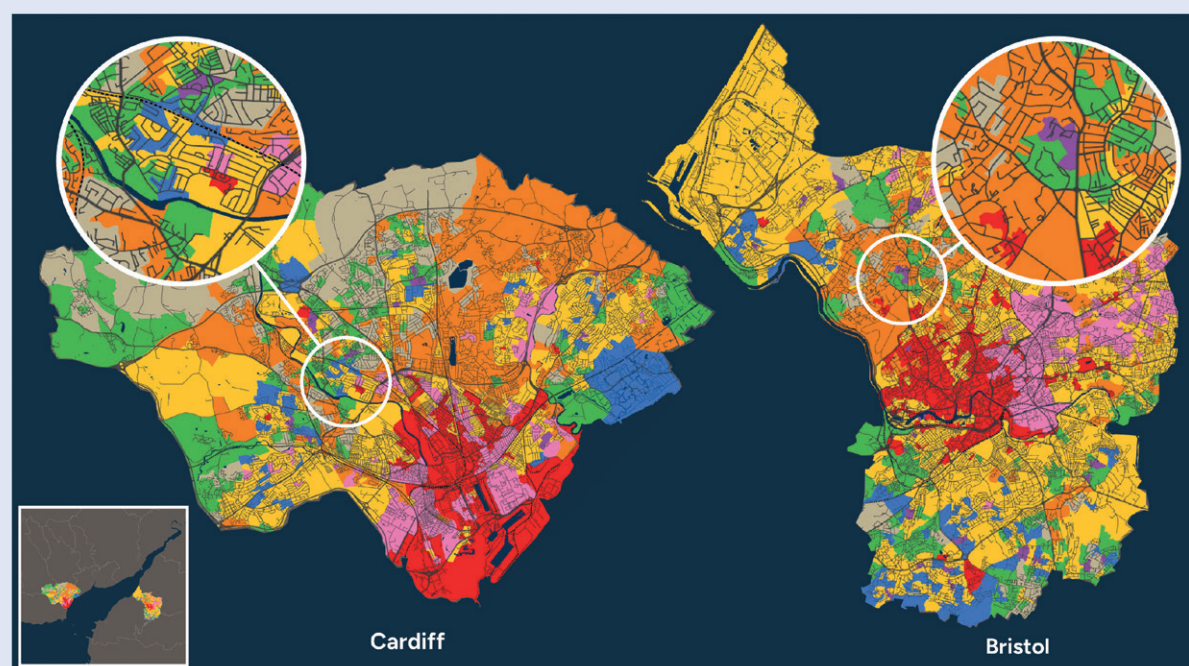
Comprehensive Residential Map

The OAC classifies small areas into one of eight Supergroup categories, which are further divided into 21 Group and 52 Subgroup categories. The classification can be used to highlight key differences between areas within the UK, and enables analysts to understand and tailor local policy responses. Further details of the classification can be read at doi.org/10.1111/geoj.12550.

The 2021/2 OAC dataset is openly available for download. A methodological paper outlining the approach taken to develop the classification, local authority atlases, pen portraits, a variable dictionary and geodata are also available.

Improving Survey Statistics

The OAC has been used to improve a number of national survey non-response models, thereby improving the accuracy of published estimates. Examples include the **Children's Dental Health Survey** delivered by the Health and Social Care Information Centre; and the ONS' **Integrated Household Survey**.



The OAC is openly available to download from data.geods.ac.uk and visible through our interactive web mapping tool mapmaker.geods.ac.uk.



Output Area Classification

- Retired Professionals
- Suburbanites & Peri-Urbanites
- Multicultural & Educated Urbanites
- Low-Skilled Migrant & Student Communities
- Ethnically Diverse Suburban Professionals
- Baseline UK
- Semi- & Un-Skilled Workforce
- Legacy Communities